Writing: A biography

💡 **Big idea:** A **biography** tells the story of a person's life in **time order**. We read about **Ahmed Bin Majid**, the famous Omani navigator known as the **Lion of the Sea**, and learn phrases to write a biography of **Dr Lamya Al Haj**, an Omani scientist.

🎯 **I will learn:**

- Talk about famous Omani people
- Read a biography and find key facts
- Use biography phrases and time expressions
- Write sentences in a biography

📖 Key words

biography سيرة ذاتية (يكتبها شخص آخر)	**navigator** ملاح	**sailor** بحار	**expertise** خبرة
compass بوصلة	**achievement** إنجاز	**graduate** يتخرج	**award** جائزة
entrepreneur رائد أعمال	**ambassador** سفير		

Ahmed Bin Majid

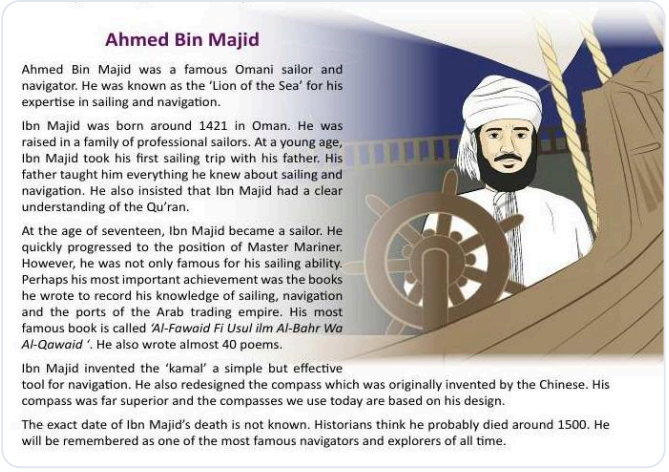
- Born around **1421** in Oman to a family of professional sailors
- Took his first sailing trip with his father at a young age, and learned the **Qur'an**
- At **seventeen** he became a sailor and soon a **Master Mariner**
- Wrote books about sailing and navigation, most famous: **Al-Fawaid Fi Usul Ilm Al-Bahr Wa Al-Qawaid**
- Invented the **kamal** and redesigned the Chinese compass, died around 1500

Dr Lamya Al Haj

- Born on 31st May 1982 in **Buraimi**, Oman
- BSc from **Sultan Qaboos University** in 2004 with high distinction
- MSc in Australia (2006) and PhD in **Molecular Biology** in London (2014)
- Received the L'Oreal UNESCO Award for Women in Science in **2018**

Useful language for biographies

- (Name) is/was a famous/well known ...
- At a young age ... / At the age of ...
- In (year) he/she ... / One year later, ...
- His/Her most important achievement was ...
- (Name) will be remembered as/for ...
- In the future, he/she hopes to ...



Ahmed Bin Majid

Ahmed Bin Majid was a famous Omani sailor and navigator. He was known as the 'Lion of the Sea' for his expertise in sailing and navigation.

Ibn Majid was born around 1421 in Oman. He was raised in a family of professional sailors. At a young age, Ibn Majid took his first sailing trip with his father. His father taught him everything he knew about sailing and navigation. He also insisted that Ibn Majid had a clear understanding of the Qu'ran.

At the age of seventeen, Ibn Majid became a sailor. He quickly progressed to the position of Master Mariner. However, he was not only famous for his sailing ability. Perhaps his most important achievement was the books he wrote to record his knowledge of sailing, navigation and the ports of the Arab trading empire. His most famous book is called *'Al-Fawaid Fi Usul ilm Al-Bahr Wa Al-Qawaid '*. He also wrote almost 40 poems.

Ibn Majid invented the 'kamal' a simple but effective tool for navigation. He also redesigned the compass which was originally invented by the Chinese. His compass was far superior and the compasses we use today are based on his design.

The exact date of Ibn Majid's death is not known. Historians think he probably died around 1500. He will be remembered as one of the most famous navigators and explorers of all time.

Biography: Ahmed Bin Majid

✏️ Examples

Why was Ibn Majid called the Lion of the Sea?

Answer: Because of his expertise in sailing and navigation.

Write a sentence about Dr Lamya with "In 2004"

Answer: In 2004, she graduated from Sultan Qaboos University with a BSc in Science.

Name three things Ibn Majid was famous for

Answer: sailing, writing books about navigation, and inventing the kamal

⭐ Remember

- Write a biography in the past simple and in time order
- Start with who the person is, end with how they will be remembered

⚠️ Watch out

- ✗ He born in 1421. ✓ He was born in 1421.
- ✗ In 2004 she graduate ✓ In 2004 she graduated

🧩 **Activity:** Write a short biography (80–100 words) of a famous Omani person

✅ Check yourself

1. When was Ibn Majid born?
2. What did he invent?
3. Where was Dr Lamya born?

Answers: (1) around 1421 ، (2) the kamal ، (3) Buraimi